

A Brief Literature Review on LaTeX

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1 Introduction

LaTeX has long been a foundational tool for scientific and technical writing, valued for its precision in mathematical typesetting and its separation of content from presentation. General overviews of the system continue to describe it as a durable point of reference in technical publishing [1]. Its visual identity, shown in Figure 1, has also become closely associated with academic and scientific writing environments.

2 Core Themes in the Literature

Two consistent themes appear in the literature: quality and control. Authors emphasize that LaTeX produces stable, high-quality typography and gives writers fine-grained control over structure and notation. A second theme is portability, where source files are plain text and easy to version, compare, and reuse. That portability also helps explain the broad disciplinary uptake discussed in Section 3, where reuse, revision, and collaboration matter.



Figure 1: The LaTeX project logo.

3 Adoption in Academic Workflows

Studies of writing practices note that LaTeX is frequently adopted in fields with heavy mathematical content, such as physics, computer science, and engineering. Its extensibility through packages also supports specialized formats for

journals and conferences, easing submission workflows. The recognisable branding in Figure 1 is consistent with that institutional longevity and with LaTeX’s visibility across academic settings.

4 Challenges and Learning Curve

While the benefits are substantial, reports also note the learning curve for new users. Authors recommend gradual onboarding, templates, and clear documentation to reduce initial friction. In longer documents, clear internal references between sections, figures, and bibliography entries can also reduce reader friction during review.

5 Conclusion

Overall, the literature presents LaTeX as a durable, standards-based platform for technical communication, with trade-offs that can be mitigated through instruction and tooling. As noted in Section 3 and in general reference material on the system [1], its continued relevance comes from the combination of typographic control, portability, and ecosystem depth.

References

- [1] Wikipedia contributors. (2026). Latex, [Online]. Available: <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/LaTeX> (visited on 04/03/2026).